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■ Sheikh Mohammed attends the UAE government's national retreat in Abu Dhabi yesterday, alongside Sheikh Mansour and Sheikh Saif.

UAE TO IRAQ: STOP HOSTILE ATTACKS

Security Council condemns strike on Barakah

DUBAI

BY STEPHEN N. R.
Senior Associate Editor

The UAE yesterday demanded that Iraq “immediately” prevent further attacks launched from its territory after a drone originating from Iraq targeted the Barakah Nuclear Power Plant, escalating regional tensions and triggering international alarm over the targeting of nuclear facilities.

The Ministry of Foreign Affairs strongly condemned the attack, which struck an electricity generator outside the plant’s inner perimeter on Sunday, describing it as a “flagrant violation” of the UAE’s sovereignty and airspace as well as a clear breach of international law and the UN Charter.

Prevent such acts

The ministry stressed that Baghdad must urgently prevent hostile acts originating from Iraqi territory and address such threats responsibly in line

The attack drew sharp condemnation at the United Nations Security Council, where member states warned of the grave dangers associated with targeting nuclear installations.

with its regional and international obligations.

It also reaffirmed Iraq’s importance as a partner in preserving regional stability, saying a stable and sovereign Iraq remained essential to wider security in the region.

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Mohamed Abushahab, the UAE’s Permanent Representative to the UN, described threats against nuclear facilities as a “red line” for the UAE.

“There were no injuries nor was there radiological release,”

he told an emergency Security Council session. “The Barakah nuclear power plant remains safe, stable and operational.”

25% electricity supply

He noted that the plant supplies up to 25 per cent of the UAE’s clean electricity and powers homes, hospitals and industries across the country. But Abushahab warned that the absence of catastrophic consequences should not reduce the seriousness of the incident.

Dr Anwar Gargash, Diplomatic Adviser to the UAE President, said the targeting of the plant by Iranian-backed militias in Iraq highlights the scale of the threats facing the region due to the absence of strong national state institutions and what he described as a clear violation of international law.

Meanwhile, Jordan’s military said it shot down a drone of unknown origin that entered its airspace yesterday near Jerash, north of Amman, underscoring fears that the regional conflict could spill further across borders.

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Indian rupee sinks to new low against dirham

Weakening currency boosts UAE remittances

DUBAI

BY JUSTIN VARGHESE
Your Money Editor

The Indian rupee has fallen to a record low against the UAE dirham, giving Gulf-based Indian expatriates

stronger remittance value when sending money home. The dirham nearly hit Rs26.30 after the rupee weakened sharply against the US dollar on Tuesday, driven by rising crude oil prices, sustained foreign investor outflows, and global market volatility.

India’s dependence on imported energy has intensified pressure on the currency as higher oil prices increase dollar demand for imports. UAE

remitters are benefiting from improved exchange rates, especially for large transfers covering school fees, loans, and household expenses in India.

Analysts say the rupee could remain under further pressure if oil prices stay elevated and capital inflows remain weak. Economists also warn that prolonged currency weakness may increase inflation and import costs in India.

Mohammed: UAE ramping up Agentic AI transformation

400 officials take part in discussions at Abu Dhabi retreat

DUBAI

BY KHITAM AL AMIR
Chief News Editor

His Highness Sheikh Mohammed Bin Rashid Al Maktoum, Vice-President and Prime Minister of the UAE and Ruler of Dubai, said the UAE was accelerating efforts to transform half of its government services and operations through artificial intelligence as part of a broader push to become a global leader in AI-driven governance.

In a post on his X account, Sheikh Mohammed said he attended the UAE government’s national retreat in Abu Dhabi alongside Sheikh Mansour Bin Zayed Al Nahyan, Vice-President, Deputy Prime Minister and Chairman of the Presi-

dential Court, and Lt. General Sheikh Saif Bin Zayed Al Nahyan, Deputy Prime Minister and Minister of Interior, to review and develop a new government system based on Agentic AI.

Applying AI

He said more than 400 officials took part in discussions focused on applying artificial intelligence across government services, operations and processes, in line with the vision of President His Highness Sheikh Mohamed Bin Zayed Al Nahyan for the UAE to become the world’s leading government in AI transformation.

Sheikh Mohammed said the first batch of AI assistants had been launched in areas including procurement, taxation, customer happiness and technical support.

The new Agentic AI system will comprise five integrated implementation tracks, each led by senior federal ministers and officials.

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